

is it true that the world is running out of fresh water because of ai?

Posted by u/Lazy_Possession8494 • • 0 points • 22 comments

I heard it in a video

[AI Anime Slop Needs To Be Stopped](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r3G1LX1ezws>) :skip to 26:16 to see the part i heard this info

Comments

u/obelix_dogmatix • 1 points • 2026-04-08 21:27 UTC

NO.

u/Mineplayerminer • 1 points • 2026-03-22 18:49 UTC

While the issue isn't widespread, it's definitely already a problem within the parts of the world where the datacenters are located, usually turning the water into Steam to power the generators or simply not dealing with the heated water in any other way than cooling it down and recirculating it again.

u/Manu442 • 1 points • 2026-03-21 18:41 UTC

See, I think we may not be looking at the bigger picture. Ai gen gets used for a lot of garbage we know that everyone does ive read there are lots of regulatory red tape to figure out a lot of the art stuff but you cant stop pervs from being gross hell, look at 80% of the internet. Im convinced thats why they invented incognito. For weirdos. Scams and crap is going to have to be a buyer beware thing. I have dug around a bit and found some studies and implementations that ai models have been used to make big improvements on the water usage in data centers and agricultural 35%efficiency implements is quite big considering no improvements have been made in many years in the agricultural industry. The problems aren't being ignored . Its the old saying,, Rome wasn't built in a day. I know there will always be more arguments and pushback. Because some dont look into what's happening and just broken record repeat the same arguments regardless of documented facts. I can sense from your writing style you look at these things with an open minded mentality not stand off ish. I appreciate that these days

u/Defiant_Conflict6343 • 3 points • 2026-03-21 02:33 UTC

It's not that the "world is running out". The problem is localised, not generalised. Two thirds of new datacentres built for generative AI have sprouted up in communities whose potable water infrastructure was already not meeting required capacity, and definitely cannot cope with the demand these datacentres make. They put such a strain on the water pressure of these communities that houses nearby find their faucets run dry and their toilets won't flush.

u/Manu442 • 0 points • 2026-03-21 00:47 UTC

Data centers use water no one is denying that . What people don't say is its not just Data centers using massive amounts of water . Agriculture industry are far bigger users its not hard to find that out

u/TyoPepe • 2 points • 2026-03-21 13:04 UTC

What's harder is to be upset about farmers using water to produce our food. "How dare they use so much water to feed the population?" is not something I've ever heard.

u/Weary-Temporary-7297 • 3 points • 2026-03-21 06:22 UTC

Comparing the water usage of data centres to other industries that provide food, shelter, clothing etc isn't really the same though. These things are essential, they are not the most efficient but they atleast provide an essential resource.

That's like the open AI guy comparing the amount of water a human drinks in their lifetime.

Artificial images and videos being spit out at an alarming rate is not essential and the data centers use up way too much water, electricity, components and not to mention takes up space that could go towards homes.

u/Manu442 • 1 points • 2026-03-21 16:54 UTC

Data centers are typically built in no housing zoned areas or industry zones. Just because something is essential doesn't mean it cant be comparable. Its all about context and measurement. Agriculture usages are used as a comparable measurement because of how massive the usage is.

u/Weary-Temporary-7297 • 2 points • 2026-03-21 17:47 UTC

Typically but not always, there have been more than enough built close to living quarters in smaller towns and it will continue.

They are non comparable when it comes to the product they produce. On one hand you have a food product, food is essential for all, the water usage in achieving it could be more efficient but it's making something everyone needs.

No one needs to be burning up the amount of water data centers use for what ever random thought pops into peoples head and want to have a laugh to see what the AI will do with it, for memes that often make no sense or could have been edited easily on a phone instead of bringing in AI, gooners to try undress celebrities and any woman on the internet, for scamming people out of money with either phony products or services.

AI generations being open to the public on more and more sites is a blight upon the land in both resources and the "content" it produces.

I'm not saying all AI is bad, if it can help in the medical field then great, maybe it can be used to figure out a more efficient agricultural use of the water.

But we don't need to be wasting water on so many data centers so every member of the public being able to churn out hundreds of thousands images a day and have a go at playing the artificial artist.

u/WheelAcrobatic5959 • 6 points • 2026-03-21 01:25 UTC

If only AI data centers gave us something to eat.

u/MechanicalGak • 0 points • 2026-03-21 01:45 UTC

You don't need Almonds specifically. Yet no one here seems concerned about that industry.

u/TyoPepe • 2 points • 2026-03-21 13:01 UTC

They don't require more water than most other trees we have. They are also productive even under great water limitation and in fact minimal irrigation is the main way to produce almond in many counties (Morocco, Spain, Italy, Iran, etc), known as dry farming or "secano".

u/MechanicalGak • 1 points • 2026-03-21 16:48 UTC

> They don't require more water than most other trees we have.

Okay, then AI uses way less than any trees.

> They are also productive even under great water limitation and in fact minimal irrigation is the main way to produce almond in many counties (Morocco, Spain, Italy, Iran, etc), known as dry farming or "secano".

And yet farmers aren't doing that as Almonds use 10x more water than AI.

u/WheelAcrobatic5959 • 2 points • 2026-03-21 03:00 UTC

Almonds are still a better reason to invest water into than revenge porn.

u/MechanicalGak • 1 points • 2026-03-21 03:18 UTC

They're a better reason to invest an order of magnitude more water?! I don't benefits you actually understand or care about water use if you think 10x more usage over the thing you hate is worth it.

And no, the vast vast majority of AI use has nothing to do with porn. Sorry.

u/WheelAcrobatic5959 • 2 points • 2026-03-21 03:23 UTC

The fact that AI bros want to negotiate removing food to preserve their stupid computer toy just shows how enormously out of touch and greedy they are.

Almonds are useful. AI is not. If I had to choose whether to waste water with agriculture or AI, I'm choosing agriculture.

You guys aren't even denying that AI is wasting water by comparing it to agriculture. You're just deflecting the issue.

u/MechanicalGak • 0 points • 2026-03-21 03:30 UTC

> The fact that AI bros want to negotiate removing food to preserve their stupid computer toy just shows how enormously out of touch and greedy they are.

Who's negotiating this? I'm just pointing out that you seem to suddenly not care about something you claimed to care about, even though the problem is literally 10x larger.

It's very telling.

u/WheelAcrobatic5959
• 2 points •
2026-03-21
03:32 UTC

What's it
telling?

u/firegine • 2 points • 2026-03-21 01:09 UTC

Why do you have double spaces?

u/Manu442 • 1 points • 2026-03-21 01:19 UTC

You should try typing with one hand with a big phone quickly